CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

RECRUITER IN THE AI ERA

Companies can't hire. Candidates can't land. The recruiter is the toll booth between them.

★ TL;DR — ~$75K median, fully remote-friendly, with a ramp of 1–6 months and no credential gate. The catch: your income and sanity ride hiring cycles — when companies freeze, recruiters starve first. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

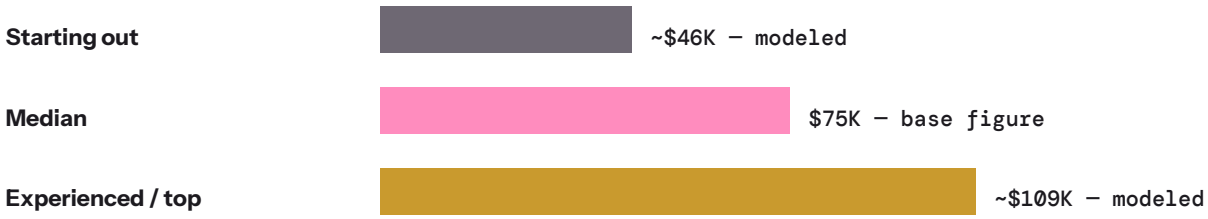
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- Every company's growth plan becomes a hiring problem someone must solve.
- The job is sales wearing a people costume: selling roles to candidates and candidates to managers.
- AI screens resumes; persuading a great candidate to actually move is human work.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Recruiter is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A RECRUITER ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Source candidates: job boards, LinkedIn, referrals, cold outreach

- ✓ Screen and interview for skills and fit
- ✓ Present shortlists and manage hiring managers' expectations
- ✓ Negotiate offers and keep candidates warm until start day

Think: a matchmaker with a quota — two sides, both picky, and the wedding is a start date.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI writes job posts, screens applications, and schedules interviews. Sourcing lists that took days now take minutes.	Judging whether someone will thrive in a specific team — and convincing a happily employed person to risk a move — takes trust and timing software can't fake.

⚠ **Recruiting is the first budget cut in a downturn. Agency recruiters eat what they kill; in-house recruiters get laid off in waves.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Remote and laptop-only ✓ Fast feedback: placements are visible wins ✓ You learn how every industry hires — priceless market knowledge	✗ Candidates ghost, managers change their minds, offers explode ✗ Your results depend on other people's decisions ✗ Cyclical: feast in hiring booms, famine in freezes

Good fit? You read people well, sell honestly, and stay organized across dozens of moving threads.
Bad fit? You need your results to depend only on you.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — STAFFING AGENCY	DOOR B — IN-HOUSE / RPO
Agencies train fast and feed you live roles immediately. It's commission-driven and intense — the classic recruiter boot camp, and where most specialists are made.	Join a company's talent team or an RPO provider. Steadier pay, deeper knowledge of one business, slower reps but a saner pace.

Smart move: Specialize in a hard-to-fill niche — skilled trades, healthcare, one tech stack. Generalist recruiters compete with software; niche recruiters get called first.
Where you land after: Senior recruiter, recruiting lead, or niche agency owner.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	PICK A	GET INTO	SOURCE LIKE	LEARN TO	OWN A

STEP 1 — Learn the hiring machine

FREE · WEEKS 1-2

- Study how hiring works: requisitions, interviews, offers, onboarding.
- Learn to read a resume and a job description critically.

STEP 2 — Pick a niche

FREE · WEEK 2

- Choose an industry you can learn deeply.
- Follow its companies, roles, and salary chatter.

STEP 3 — Get into an agency or team

PAID · MONTHS 1-2

- Apply to staffing agencies and junior in-house roles.
- Sell your people-reading and your hustle — that's the interview.

STEP 4 — Source like a machine

WORKING · MONTHS 2-3

- Build Boolean search skills and outreach templates that don't sound robotic.
- Fill your first pipeline and present your first shortlist.

STEP 5 — Learn to close candidates

WORKING · MONTHS 3-5

- Run real offer negotiations with mentor backup.
- Track why candidates say no — patterns are your education.

STEP 6 — Own a desk

WORKING · MONTHS 5-6

- Carry your own roles end to end.
- Build a bench of pre-sold candidates in your niche.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: pick your niche and read 20 real job posts in it.

□ Days 1–30: applications out to agencies; sourcing practice daily.

□ Days 31–60: in a seat, screening real candidates, first shortlists going out.

□ Days 61–90: first interviews coordinated and first offer in motion.

□ Day 90: you're running live roles — placements, not potential, are the metric from here.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ GREAT HIRES ARE FOUND, NOT POSTED. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.